

Decoding DISC

Interactive workplace communication course

Audience: Employees and people managers

Challenge: DISC is often taught as a set of personality labels, which can make the framework easy to remember but easy to misuse.

Solution: A practical course focused on recognising communication cues, adapting how messages are delivered, and using DISC without reducing colleagues to fixed types.

My role: Instructional design · Content development · Interaction design · Articulate Rise 360 development · Visual design · Assessment design

Tools: Articulate Rise 360 · TalentLMS

Key features: Scenario-based practice · Labeled graphic · Sorting activity · Tabs · Process interaction · Final assessment · Downloadable job aid

Design decisions: Reduced theory-heavy content and removed elements that did not directly support workplace application. Structured the course around a simple Notice → Hypothesise → Flex → Check model, then used realistic communication scenarios so learners could practise adapting their approach without treating DISC as a fixed label.

Accessibility: Added meaningful alt text, avoided using colour alone to communicate DISC styles, and kept key learning available as text.

Quality assurance: Reviewed terminology, source attribution, UK English consistency, learner feedback, and assessment alignment.

Testing: Published as SCORM and tested end-to-end in TalentLMS.



DS

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Decoding DISC

[START COURSE](#)

Ever wonder why one coworker wants the bottom line immediately, while another needs time to talk things through or review the details first? Differences in communication style can easily lead to frustration, misunderstandings, or conversations that simply don't land.

In this course, you'll use DISC as a practical framework for noticing communication preferences at work. You'll learn how to recognize common behavioural cues, adjust the way you communicate, and respond more effectively in everyday workplace situations—without reducing people to labels or putting them into boxes.

[Ask AI Tutor](#)

Spot the Clues

Lesson 3 of 10

Start with behaviour, not the label

Instead of asking 'What type is this person?', ask 'What am I noticing right now?' Look for clues in pace, directness, focus on people or outcomes, and appetite for detail.

A practical DISC observation map



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People Aren't Letters

Lesson 4 of 10

Patterns matter more than moments

People can show different behaviours depending on the situation. One direct comment does not make someone a D. One request for data does not make someone a C. Look for patterns, and stay ready to revise your read.

Meet Maya in three situations

EXECUTIVE UPDATE

COACHING A NEW
COLLEAGUE

REVIEWING A BUDGET

Maya opens with: 'Bottom line: the launch is still on track. I need one decision from you today.'

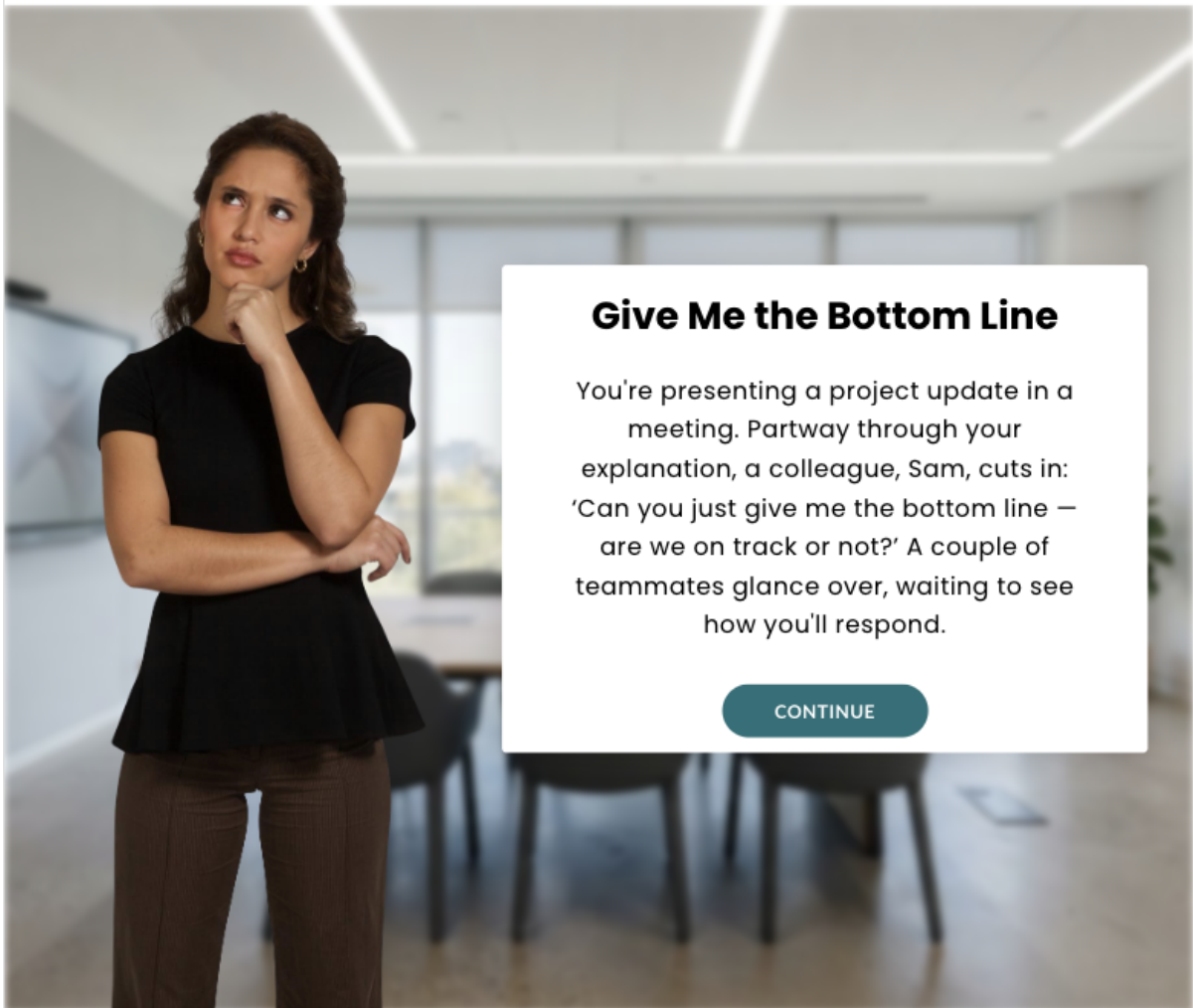


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Practice: Adapting the Message

Lesson 5 of 10



Give Me the Bottom Line

You're presenting a project update in a meeting. Partway through your explanation, a colleague, Sam, cuts in: 'Can you just give me the bottom line — are we on track or not?' A couple of teammates glance over, waiting to see how you'll respond.

CONTINUE

Next:

Flexing your approach

CONTINUE

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Your Communication Toolkit

Lesson 6 of 10

Flexing isn't faking

Flexing your style means adjusting how you communicate — pace, detail level, tone — to meet someone where they are. It's not about pretending to be a different person or telling someone what they want to hear. You're still saying the same thing; you're just choosing the delivery that actually lands.

Quick-adjust by style

When you notice...

D-LEANING CUES

I-LEANING CUES

S-LEANING CUES

C-LEANING CUES

Fast, direct, focused on decisions and outcomes

- **Likely need:** bottom line, speed, clarity
- **Try:** lead with the conclusion and decision needed
- **Example:** "Bottom line: we're on track. I need one decision from you."



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Try it Tomorrow

Lesson 10 of 10

One conversation. One adjustment.

In your next meeting, choose one person. Notice one cue.

Flex one thing about your delivery. Then watch what happens.

Take the job aid with you



Flex the Message Job Aid.pdf
21.9 KB



Sources & Further Reading

1

William Moulton Marston — *Emotions of Normal People* (1928)

The original theoretical work that introduced the behavioural ideas later associated with DISC. Marston did not create the modern DISC assessment.

2

Everything DiSC — History of DiSC

An overview of how Marston's ideas were later developed into DISC-based

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Decoding DISC

Overview Users Learning activities Unit matrix Timeline



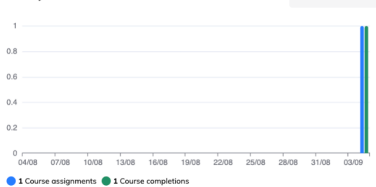
Decoding DISC

Export in Excel

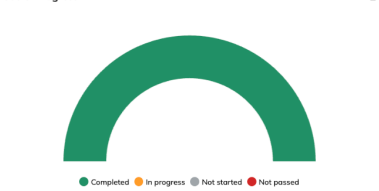
Overview

Completion rate	100.00%
Completed	1
In progress	0
Not passed	0
Not started	0
Training time	4m

Activity



Users' Progress



Average completion time



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Overview Users SCORM analysis Timeline

Search

User	Completion date	Progress status	Score	Training time	
D. Shchygoleva	04/09/2026	Passed	100.00%	4m 20s	...

